

Personal Research & Documentation Standard

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Purpose

This standard defines the methodology I will follow throughout the remaining seven weeks of the CloudMavin Cybersecurity Fellowship. It establishes consistent procedures for research, note-taking, documentation, evidence collection, version control, and reporting so that every practical task is accurate, reproducible, and professionally presented.

1. Note-Taking Standard

All learning activities will be documented in Obsidian. Notes will be organized by week and task. Every note will include the date, objective, activities performed, important concepts, commands used, findings, and lessons learned. Reflection notes will be written after each lab to reinforce understanding.

2. File Naming Standard

Files will use a consistent format such as Week1_Task1_Lab_Setup_Report, Week1_Task3_Command_Log, and Week1_Task3_Screenshot_01. File names will be descriptive, use underscores instead of spaces where appropriate, and include the week and task number.

3. Documentation & Evidence Standard

Every practical task will include an Executive Summary, Methodology, Technical Details, Commands Used (where applicable), Screenshots & Evidence, Findings, Risk Rating, Recommendations, Lessons Learned, References, and an AI Usage Declaration. Screenshots will capture significant milestones and will be renamed before storage.

4. Source Citation Standard

Priority will be given to official documentation such as NIST, MITRE ATT&CK, NICE Framework, Kali Linux, TryHackMe, Hack The Box, OWASP, and vendor documentation. External information will be verified before inclusion.

5. Version Control & Backup

GitHub will serve as the primary version-control platform. Commits will be made after meaningful progress using descriptive messages. Local copies will be stored in Windows folders, working notes in Obsidian, and submission copies in Google Drive to ensure redundancy.

6. AI Usage

Artificial Intelligence will be used only to support learning, clarify concepts, improve report structure, and review documentation quality. All practical activities, analysis, screenshots, testing, and conclusions will be completed and verified personally.

Conclusion

By following this standard consistently throughout the fellowship, I will maintain organized evidence, produce professional technical reports, and build a high-quality cybersecurity portfolio that demonstrates both technical competence and disciplined documentation practices.